



VANDERBILT UNIVERSITY
Owen Graduate School of Management

Marketing Management BUS1600

Alumni Hall 201

2 Credits

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appointment**

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The job of marketing is to cultivate sustainable growth for the brand and drive brand value. In this course, we will explore the foundational tools used broadly across organizations to effectively manage marketing strategy. This course is relevant for both marketers and non-marketers.

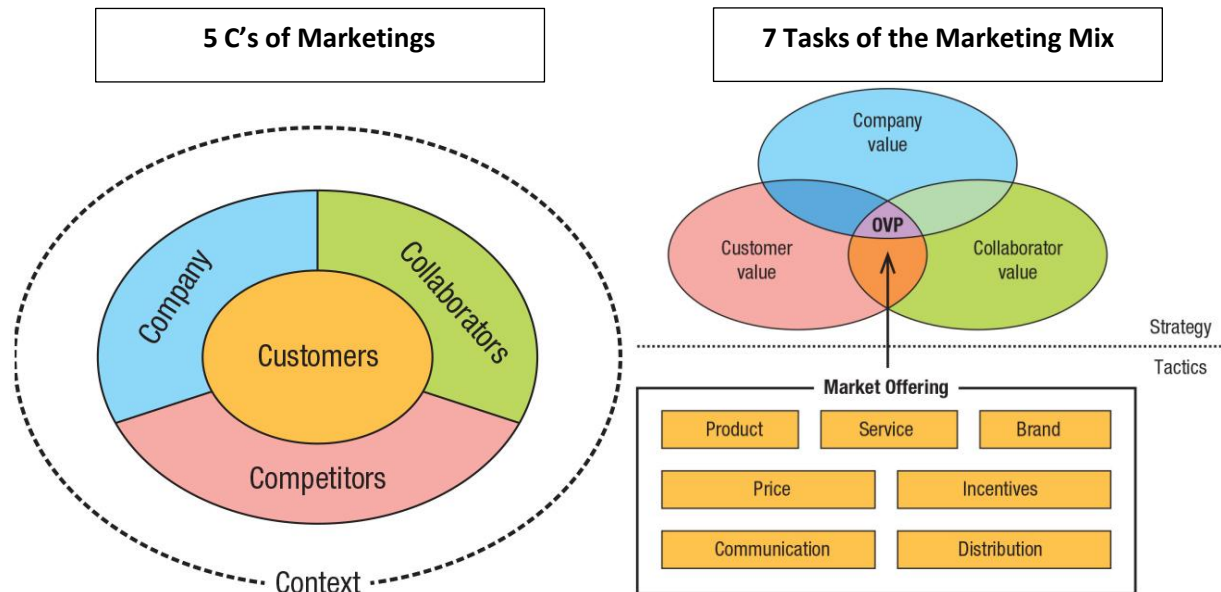
I teach the course with a focus on training students to become leaders in their profession. Course content, grading, and other feedback are designed to encourage students to think critically and compete for senior-level positions in your chosen profession. From my experience, most senior leaders are better strategists and leaders than they are mathematicians. So, we will cover a wide variety of topics that will help ground you in today's field of marketing.

I am a marketer by profession and an Economist by education. This means I teach my courses with an eye to digesting and managing risk. Choosing a career in any profession comes with the potential to fail. This class will put a lens on making good decisions that will facilitate professional success and career longevity.

I make considerable efforts to ensure an inclusive environment for all students. I will respect every student in this class as an individual with distinct experiences, talents, and backgrounds. I treat students fairly regardless of race, religion, sexual orientation, gender identification, disability, socio-economic status, or national identity. I also make the material accessible to students with disabilities. This might include different assignment formats. Issues of diversity will be a part of class discussion, assigned material, and projects.

Overview

Today, more than ever before, companies rely on marketing campaigns and insights to support the delivery of personalized, customer-centric marketing communications. This course introduces students to the concepts utilized by medium, large, and startup enterprises. Particular emphasis will be placed on the development and application of foundational concepts in marketing:



Course Learning Goals

- Understand the role of marketing within society and within an economic system.
- Learn key marketing principles and concepts and understand the vital role of marketing within a firm.
- Consider the various decision areas within marketing and the tools and methods used by marketing managers for making decisions
- Appreciate how a marketing perspective is important in your own personal and professional Development

My course provides a mix of "academic" and "professional" skills. By the end of this course, you should be able to, at a minimum:

- Effective execution of targeting and segmentation
- Strategies for arriving at optimal pricing
- Execute marketing that enhances (and does not hurt) brand equity
- Building consensus for your brands' marketing strategy

Your goals:

We will discuss those, and you will keep track of whether we are meeting them or not.

Required Text:

Kotler, P., Keller, K. L., & Chernev, A. (2025). *Marketing management* (17th ed.). Pearson. ISBN: 978-9367130629

Note: Be sure to purchase Edition 17 and not 17e. The latter is much more expensive and not needed for this course. As of this writing, [you can purchase a Kindle copy for \\$12.58 on Amazon](#).

Harvard Cases are outlined in your course content. Cases and articles include:

1. **Opera Philadelphia: Segmentation Strategies for Changing Markets, Product Number:** W19419-PDF-ENG
2. **ECOALF: Fashion for the Future, Product Number:** 524057-PDF-ENG
3. **Thinking Outside the Wine Box (A): Mekanism and the Franz for Life Campaign, Product Number:** 522055-PDF-ENG
4. **Sustainability through Simply Good Jars, Product Number:** W28631-PDF-ENG
5. **The End of Rational Economics, Product Number:** R0907H-PDF-ENG

Juxtaposition of Text and Lectures:

I expect you to read the text. It provides a foundational understanding of the discipline, but I will not cover all the content in my lectures. Rather, I will use our class time to explain how marketing concepts work in a business context.

The Brightspace course site is always the best and most up-to-date place to look for what is due. Our calendar is determined by the needs of the class and what happens in the world. In particular, all class announcements will be posted on the Brightspace announcement page. Visit it regularly to avoid confusion.

Points and Grading* (*SUBJECT TO a small degree of CHANGE*)

Feedback and grades for all assessments are delivered to students via the Brightspace Grades tool. Grading follows the criteria outlined in each assignment/assessment. Grades are typically released within five business days from the due date. I generally send individual communication via Brightspace to students whose work may require additional attention (e.g., problem with submission, missing submission, etc.).

- 30% Midterm Case Writeup
- 25% Final Exam
- 20% Group Assignments (4 assignments, 5 points apiece)
- 10% Attendance
- 10% Individual assignment
- 5% Research Participation
- +2% Extra Credit

Midterm Case Writeup

To meet the "commercial-ready" standard, your report should be organized into five critical sections:

1. Executive Summary

Provide a high-level overview of the current situation.

- **The Hook:** What is the most pressing challenge or opportunity?
- **The Ask:** What decision needs to be made immediately?
- **The Bottom Line:** State your recommended course of action and fact-based support

2. Situational Diagnosis (The "Why")

Avoid summarizing the case; the executives already know their history. Instead, provide a critical analysis of the current market landscape using core marketing frameworks. Incorporate the 5C's and SWOT analysis into your assessment.

3. Strategic Alternatives

The case outlines three alternative strategies. Be clear on which strategy you recommend.

4. Recommendation & Implementation (The "How")

- Include 3 to 4 recommendations. Outline the recommended target segments (remember to review the segmentation Excel workbook carefully). Also apply the **Marketing Mix** (7 Tasks: Product, Service, Brand, Price, Incentives, Communications, Distribution) when applicable. There is no requirement to use all marketing mix tasks.

5. Risk Mitigation

What could go wrong? A C-level deliverable is incomplete without acknowledging risks. Identify the top two risks of your recommendation and explain how the company will pivot if they occur.

The deliverable you hand in (not your in-class presentation) will be graded. **The case write-up will count as 30% of your final grade.**

Technical Specifications & Honor Code

Feature	Requirement
Length	Max 3 pages of text + supplemental exhibits.
Formatting	Minimum 10pt font. Professional, clean layout.

Feature	Requirement
Deadline	September 15 th , 2026
Constraint	Stay within the timeframe of the case. Do not use hindsight or "future" data not available in the text.
Integrity	No outside research or consultation with former students.

Grading Rubric

Criteria	Weight	Expectation
Analytical Rigor	40%	Deep use of 5Cs, Marketing Mix, Segmentation, Targeting, Brand Positioning, and SWOT; insights must go beyond the obvious.
Strategic Alignment	30%	Does the analysis support your recommendations? Can the recommendations be implemented?
Correct application of course concepts	20%	Are course contents (segmentation, brand positioning, marketing mix, 5C's situation) correctly used?
Professionalism	10%	Formatting, clarity, and persuasive "voice."

Tips for Success

- **Think Like an Owner:** What guidance do you have for the Executive Director and his management team?
- **The "So What?" Test:** Every data point or exhibit you include should pass the "So What?" test. If it doesn't lead directly to a decision or insight, cut it.
- **Persuasion vs. Description:** Use active language. Instead of saying "The market is growing," say "We must capture the 15% growth in the millennial segment before Competitor X builds brand loyalty."

Midterm Case Writeup is worth 30% of your total grade.

Final Exam is worth 25% of your total grade. It will be comprehensive of all the content we learned during the semester and include forty (40) multiple-choice and ten (10) short-answer questions.

Group Projects are worth 20% of your total grade (5% per assignment). Students will submit four group assignments (each assignment will be posted as per the calendar below). These assignments will ask you to apply the concepts learned in class in various ways. Two of the assignments will be completed in class, two will be completed out of class.

Individual Project is worth 10% of your total grade. You will be asked to apply the contents of the course to an analytic marketing problem.

Attendance is worth 10% of your total grade. Student attendance is expected in all classes. However, students will be given unlimited excused absences (i.e., does not count against their attendance grade) provided the student sends the Professor or TA sufficient advanced notice (i.e., prior to class; please email: eric.d.hogue@vanderbilt.edu) and the reason is a university-sanctioned reason (i.e., official Vanderbilt business) or approved by the Professor (i.e., sick). If the reason is unjustified, the student will be considered unexcused and have points deducted from their class attendance. If you need more flexibility, please meet with a Student Success representative ([Student Care Coordination](#)).

Research Participation is worth 5% of your total grade. Consumer behavior and other business-related behavioral sciences rely heavily on data and an understanding of various research methods. Therefore, exposure to the research process is an invaluable and practical learning experience for students pursuing a career in business-related fields. At Vanderbilt University, students enrolled in Business 1600 as part of the Business Minor Program are required to participate in up to **two one-hour research sessions** at the Owen Insights Lab. This participation is designed to familiarize students with the objectives, methodologies, and outcomes of business-related research. In these sessions, you will engage with studies covering a broad spectrum of business topics.

Your participation in two hours of research will constitute 5% of your final grade in Business 1600. Specifically, you can attend up to two research sessions during the course, with each session contributing 2.5% to your total grade. The deadlines for completing these sessions are outlined in your syllabus calendar and on the SONA website: <https://vanderbilt-owen.sona-systems.com>.

To participate, you must first register for an account at <https://vanderbilt-owen.sona-systems.com>. Upon completing your registration, you will receive emails from the research administrators with further instructions on how to sign up for sessions. The research sessions will be conducted at The Center Building, located on campus at 2014 Broadway, Suite 245 (<https://goo.gl/maps/vMCwS>), situated on the second floor of the building. Additional information will be provided via email once you have registered for SONA. For any inquiries, please contact ResearchAdmin@vanderbilt.edu.

Important Note: This module includes two distinct session windows. To earn the full 5%, you must participate once during each window. Participating twice during the same window will not count. **If you do not complete Session 1 by September 17, you will no longer be able to earn the full 5% for the module.**

Mod 1 Session Schedule:

Session 1: September 8th to September 17th

Session 2: September 29th to October 8th

FAQs:

- **Where are you located?**
 - We are located at 2014 Broadway in Suite 245 inside the Center Building. Please enter from the second floor (the first floor is normally locked) and follow signs to the Insights Lab. Because the Insights Lab can be difficult to navigate, we highly recommend that you plan on arriving 5-10 minutes early for your first time visiting the lab.
- **Can I participate twice in Session 1 (or 2)?**
 - No. To receive the full 5%, you must participate once during Session 1 (September 8 through September 17) and once during Session 2 (September 29 through October 8). You cannot participate twice in one session.
- **I am running a bit late; can I still participate?**
 - Because of the nature of the studies we run in the lab, once a session starts, we are unable to allow anyone else to participate for that timeslot. Research sessions start exactly on time, and so if you're more than a few minutes late, you likely will not be able to participate in a research session for that given time. We recommend that you plan on arriving 5 – 10 minutes early for your first session to avoid these scenarios.
- **What do I do if I am unable to make it to my scheduled appointment?**
 - While we appreciate your timeliness and attendance at scheduled sessions, we understand that conflicts arise. You may cancel your appointment through SONA. If you need to cancel fewer than 24 hours before your appointment, you must email the lab at ResearchAdmin@Vanderbilt.edu.

- **I have questions about my credit or participation. Should I contact my professor or the lab?**
 - For all questions, concerns, inquiries, graduation announcements, etc., please contact the lab at ResearchAdmin@Vanderbilt.edu. Because your privacy and confidentiality are held to the highest standards at the Insights Lab, instructors and professors only receive a limited amount of information regarding your participation in each research session. Thus, reaching out to the lab is your quickest (and easiest) method of solving any issues you may be having.

Extra Credit (2% on final grade): If you believe your true performance in the course is not reflected in your grade, I will offer an Extra Credit assignment that will allow you to earn as much as +2% on your final grade.

Starbucks' "Ube & Energy" Global Launch: Following their 2026 "Back to Starbucks" turnaround, the company is launching a new line of customizable, protein-forward energy refreshers. Plan the North American rollout to recapture the Gen Z afternoon "pick-me-up" occasion.

Write a five-page (maximum) marketing plan. If you can do it in fewer pages, even better. The document should be in memo format and include the following sections:

- Situation Analysis – Remember to integrate the 5C's into your narrative
- Strategy: Consumer targeting (segmentation), brand positioning, and marketing mix.
- Implementation – Marketing calendar with media channels (e.g., TV, social media, point of purchase, etc.).

All marketing plans must be uploaded to Brightspace by 11:59 PM on October 13th, 2026. The midterm grading rubric will be followed, awarding extra credit.

I accept late work on group and individual assignments, but with a penalty: 1 day to 7 days (20%), 8 days to 14 days (50%); no work will be accepted beyond 14 days after the due date. All assignments must be completed and turned in by October 13th, 11:59 PM CT.

Grading Scale:

Scale Range	Letter Grade	Grade Point Average
93.0–100	A	4.0
90.0–92.9	A–	3.7
87.0–89.9	B+	3.3
83.0–86.9	B	3.0
80.0–82.9	B–	2.7
77.0–79.9	C+	2.33
73.0–76.9	C	2.0
70.0–72.9	C–	1.7
67.0–69.9	D+	~1.3
63.0–66.9	D	1.0
60.0–62.9	D–	~0.7
0–59.9	F	failing

Communication Policy

I strive to respond to individual messages within 24 hours of receipt. For an urgent matter, please email the address indicated, which I regularly monitor, using URGENT in the subject line. Communication with the class will be delivered via announcements in the course Brightspace, and you are expected to check in on Brightspace regularly (you are encouraged to set your Brightspace notifications to receive alerts from the course Brightspace site). Feedback on assignments will be delivered via the Brightspace Grades tool.

Course Conduct

You can be expelled from school if you are found guilty of academic misconduct. This includes cheating on exams, turning in work that is not your own and providing or accepting outside help on assignments. **Use of AI must be sourced to its original source (not the large language model e.g. ChatGPT.com). Also, do not upload any text or cases to an LLM. In some cases, this violates the terms and conditions of these resources and may result in disciplinary action.** I will host several AI tasks in class to familiarize you with potential uses and limitations.

I encourage you to discuss assignments with your classmates, but all submitted work must be original (for group projects, work should be completed within your team). We will discuss this at greater length in the first few weeks of class. It is the responsibility of all Vanderbilt students to know and adhere to the College's policy on plagiarism and the Honor Code. Read this if you have questions concerning the Vanderbilt's [plagiarism policy](#) and [Honor Code](#).

Support for Students with Disabilities <https://studenthandbook.vanderbilt.edu/>

Vanderbilt is committed to providing equal access and support to students with disabilities, through the provision of reasonable accommodations, to allow them to fully participate in Vanderbilt's programs and activities. If you have a disability that may require accommodations, please contact the [Student Access Center](#). Students are encouraged to contact SAC early in the semester. Please be aware that accommodations are not applied retroactively.

Class Recording

No one may record any part of this class unless the faculty member has given them express permission to do so. Students who require that a class be recorded due to a disability should work with the Student Access Center to receive an accommodation for that recording. This class is considered a private environment, and it is a setting in which copyrighted materials, creative works, and educational records may be displayed. Audio or video recording, photographing, transmitting, or publishing the images of those materials or educational records without express consent is strictly prohibited. Any student who records a class without the faculty's permission without a registered accommodation will be referred to the Office of Community Standards. Accommodations for recording a class will be honored by your instructor.

Religious Accommodations

Students who may have a conflict with a course requirement due to a sincerely held religious belief, practice, or observance should work with the instructor as soon as possible to identify an accommodation that satisfies the specific need of the student while maintaining the necessary academic requirements. The student will then work with their instructor to find a mutually acceptable way to make up any missed coursework and/or assignments. Any student absence for a religious observance will count toward the total number of absences permitted in the course under the instructor's written attendance policy. For more information, see the Student Religious Accommodation Policy.

Name Changes, Gender Identity, and Pronouns

Whenever possible, please notify your instructor of your name or gender pronoun early in the semester, or as you are comfortable doing so.

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES:

- Vanderbilt has multiple resources available to assist students:
- The Student Care Network: <https://www.vanderbilt.edu/studentcarenetwork/>
- Office of Student Care Coordination: <https://www.vanderbilt.edu/carecoordination/>
- Project Safe Center for Sexual Misconduct: <https://www.vanderbilt.edu/projectsafe>
- Title IX office: <https://www.vanderbilt.edu/title-ix/>
- Vanderbilt University Police Department: 615-421-1911

Schedule

Date	Topic	Preparation	Assignment Due/Testing
8/27/2026	Course Introduction	Read MM Chapters 1 and 2	Group Assignment 1: Read "ECOALF" case and work with your team on the assignment
9/1/2026	Customer Centricity	Read MM Chapters 4 and 5	Create SONA account for research participation (due Wed, 9/1 at 5 pm)
9/3/2026	Marketing Research	Read MM Chapter 19	Guest Speaker: Ryan Group Assignment 1 (Due, 11:59PM)
9/8/2026	Segmentation, Targeting and Positioning	Read Chapter 6 and 7.1 (ignore rest of Chapter 7), Harvard Business Case: Opera Philadelphia	Midterm Case Discussion: Opera Philadelphia
9/10/2026	Consumer Behavior	Read Chapter 3	Read "Simply Good Jars" case
9/15/2026	Behavioral Economics	Read HBR article: End of Rational Economics	Midterm Case Write-up (Due, 11:59PM)
9/17/2026	Product	Read Chapter 18	Group Assignment 2 - In Class
9/22/2026	Branding	Read Chapter 10	Read Individual Marketing Research Assignment
9/24/2026	Pricing beyond Cost	Read Chapter 11	Group Assignment 3 Assigned in Class, Guest Speaker
9/29/2026	Distribution	Read Chapter 15	Group Assignment 3, (Due: 11:59PM)
10/1/2026	Promotion and Advertising	Read Chapter 12	Individual Case Assignment, (Due: 11:59PM) Group Assignment 4: Read "Thinking Outside the Wine Box" case and work with your team on the assignment
10/6/2026	Digital Marketing	Read Chapter 13	Group Assignment 4 - In Class
10/8/2026	Review		
10/13/2026	Final Exam		